

SUPPORTING AUSTRALIAN GENERAL PRACTICE NURSES TO SCREEN AND ADVISE ON HEALTHY MOVEMENT BEHAVIOURS: A CO-DESIGN PROJECT

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INTRODUCTION

Primary healthcare provides an important setting to promote healthy movement behaviours (physical activity and sedentary behaviour reduction) among populations who are insufficiently active and/or highly sedentary. Although general practice nurses can feasibly deliver screening and brief advice on healthy movement behaviours, practical implementation resources supporting nurses to routinely deliver such interventions are needed.

The purpose of this research study was to co-design an active living toolkit supporting general practice nurses to implement movement behaviour screening and brief advice within Australian primary healthcare.

METHODS

Guided by the Double Diamond framework [1], this participatory study represents the Define and Develop phases of a broader co-design process (see Figure 1). The preceding Discover phase (n=19 participants) informed two iterative in-depth online co-design workshops with four general practice nurses to develop and refine the toolkit.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

Four core toolkit components identified from the Discover phase were prioritised: (1) education and

training, (2) a movement behaviour screening tool, (3) patient and clinician support materials and (4) local activity directories. Participants informed the development of a prototype education module designed to increase nurses' knowledge and capability. The adapted Physical Activity and Sitting Time Balance Index [2] screening tool was identified as useful and engaging, with integration into practice management software important for supporting usability.

CONCLUSIONS

Throughout the Define and Develop phases, general practice nurses informed the co-design of a highly relevant toolkit supporting movement behaviour screening and brief advice. The subsequent Deliver phase aims to evaluate the feasibility and implementation of toolkit components within a real-world clinical practice.

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- [1] Design Council. Framework for Innovation. 2026.
- [2] Botlero et al. *Am J Prev Med* 67(6):832-40, 2024.

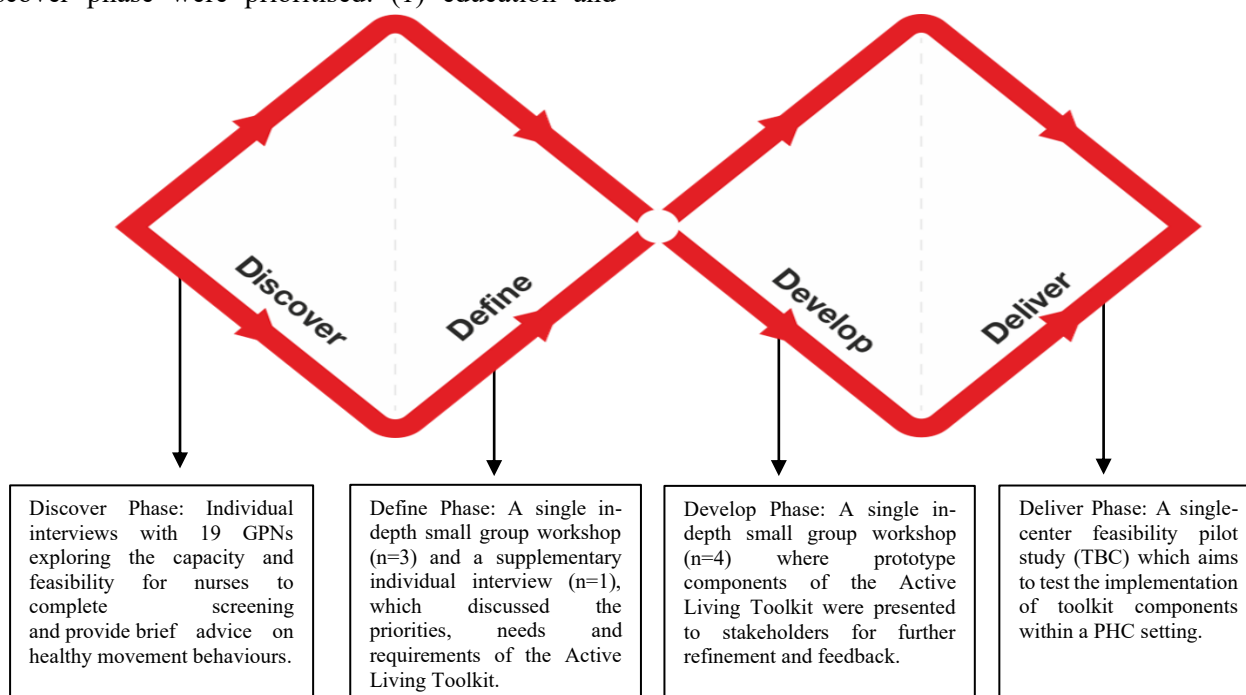


Figure 1: The Double Diamond Design Approach used to develop the Active Living Toolkit components [1].